

Whistleblower Policy

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Table of Contents

Purpose: 3
Scope: 3
Abbreviations & Definitions: 3
Roles and Responsibilities 3
Detailed Policy Statement 4
General Guidelines 4
Disqualifications from Making Protected Disclosures 4
Process for Making Protected Disclosure 4
Protection from Retaliation 5
Investigations and Reporting: 5
Related Policies Procedure References 5

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Purpose:

The Whistleblower policy is designed to encourage Board members, leadership, staff (paid and volunteer), and others to report suspected or actual occurrences of illegal, unethical, or inappropriate events without fear of retribution. This policy aims to uphold integrity, transparency, and accountability within the organization while ensuring a safe environment for all stakeholders.

Scope:

Applies to all employees, contractors, vendors, and stakeholders of the organizations.

Abbreviations & Definitions:

Investigators: Individuals or groups authorized or consulted by the Group CISO, which may include Aithent's auditors and law enforcement.

Protected Disclosure: Any report made in good faith by an employee or director revealing unethical, illegal, or improper behaviour that violates Aithent's Code of Conduct.

Subject: The individual against whom a Protected Disclosure has been made.

Whistleblower: Personnels who makes a report under this Policy.

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee/Whistle-blower	• Report unethical or unlawful practices witnessed at Aithent as whistle-blowers. • Submit written complaints through the defined helpline in the policy. • Refrain from engaging in investigative activities or acting as finders of facts.
Audit Committee of the Company	• Receive written complaints and review the performance of investigating agencies. • Determine the need for investigation and select investigating agencies. • Monitor investigation progress and receive investigation findings. • Review and monitor corrective actions initiated to prevent/minimize recurrence of events. • Keep the identity of whistle-blowers confidential. • Recommend corrective actions against protected disclosures. • Decide on disciplinary action based on the final investigation report.

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Investigator or Investigating Agency/Committee	• Conduct investigations as per defined terms of reference. • Keep the identity of whistle-blowers confidential.

Detailed Policy Statement

General Guidelines

- This Policy sets out the process for reporting and investigating unethical and unlawful practices.
- Whistle-blowers should report reliable information and refrain from conducting investigative activities.
- All Protected Disclosures by employees shall be handled by the HR.
- This policy does not apply to personal grievances or complaints dealt with under existing Aithent policies.
- Aithent encourages all employees and directors to disclose any information or suspicion of fraud or illegal acts.
- Activities or behaviours that should be reported under this policy may include, but are not limited to, the following:
  - ✓ Breaches of laws, rules, and regulations in India (Gurugram & Chennai).
  - ✓ Other criminal or illegal actions.
  - ✓ Serious negligence, misconduct, or omissions.
  - ✓ Misappropriation of funds, securities, supplies, or other assets through fraudulent means.
  - ✓ Falsifying records, such as payrolls, by removing or replacing documents with fraudulent ones.
  - ✓ Intentionally withholding facts or deceiving in matters like appointments, placements, or report submissions, leading to unfair gains or losses.
  - ✓ Engaging in any anti-competitive behaviour.
  - ✓ Committing criminal offenses.
  - ✓ Any other behaviour that may be considered unlawful or fraudulent towards stakeholders.

Disqualifications from Making Protected Disclosures

- Employees making false, fraudulent, or malicious Protected Disclosures may face disciplinary action, including termination.
- Whistleblowers making repeated false or malicious disclosures may be disqualified from reporting further disclosures.
- Whistleblowers found complicit may not be protected from disciplinary proceedings.

Process for Making Protected Disclosure

- Protected disclosures should be addressed to the Group CISO.

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- Employees should submit written complaints using email address: whistleblower@aithent.com.
- Anonymous disclosures will not be entertained.
- Disclosures should be factual, containing adequate details and evidence.

Protection from Retaliation

- Whistleblowers shall be protected from unfair treatment, discrimination, or retribution.
- Aithent condemns any unfair employment practices against whistleblowers.
- Whistleblowers reporting retaliation shall inform the HR for investigation.
- The identity of whistleblowers shall be kept confidential.

Investigations and Reporting:

- Investigators shall be recommended by the Group CISO, depending on the seriousness and complexity of issues.
- Investigators must conduct fair, objective, and thorough investigations.
- Investigations will be initiated based on a preliminary review of disclosed information.
- If an investigation concludes that an improper or unethical act has been committed, the Group CISO shall recommend corrective actions to the senior management.
- Disciplinary or corrective actions shall adhere to applicable personnel or staff conduct procedures.
- The Audit Committee shall submit annual reports to management on all Protected Disclosures, along with investigation results.

Related Policies Procedure References

- Aithent's Code of Conduct
- Disciplinary Action Procedure

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